GENERAL ENGLISH • MODULE 1 (TRAVEL, TRANSPORT & LEISURE)

Session 3: Overtourism & Tourism Policy

Managing Visitor Numbers, Protecting Local Communities & Municipal Regulations in Spoken English

Student: _____ **Group:** GSEA25_ (A / B) **Date:** _____ **Partner:** _____

📌 Lesson Summary & Spoken English Context

In this 2-hour communicative session, students examine the international crisis of mass tourism across Europe and global fragile ecosystems. Working in collaborative pairs and stakeholder teams, students evaluate carrying capacity data in Venice, Dubrovnik, and Amsterdam, pitch municipal regulations (daily entrance levies, cruise bans, Airbnb quotas) to the city mayor, master causatives of authority and contrast connectors, and resolve a high-stakes resource shortage in the Isla Serena DDRS simulation.

🎯 Session Objectives (CEFR B2 Communicative Competencies)

#	Target Competency	Operational Learning Outcome
01	**Core Vocabulary**	Accurately use 18 mass tourism terms (carrying capacity, visitor dispersal, honey-pot destination, tourist levy) in debate.
02	**Fluency & Paraphrasing**	Describe acute tourism pressures and resident displacement under time pressure without stumbling.
03	**Grammar: Causatives**	Explain municipal authority and enforcement rules using structures like *have/make someone do* and *require to*.
04	**Grammar: Contrast**	Balance economic revenue against social and ecological harm using connectors (*despite, in spite of, whereas*).
05	**Spoken Pronunciation**	Place correct syllable stress on policy words (*ca-PA-ci-ty, re-gu-la-TO-ry, de-mar-ke-ting, sa-tu-RA-tion*).
06	**Stakeholder Negotiation**	Defend stakeholder interests (Mayor, Hotelier, Farmer, Regulator) in a 4-way round-table negotiation to reach unanimous accord.
07	**Business TOEIC Skills**	Recognize distractor traps involving causative verbs and contrast prepositions in professional reading tests.

📄 7-Page Lesson Worksheet Architecture

Page	Session Stage	Communicative Task	Deliverable / Verification
Page 1	Overview & Index	Syllabus alignment & competencies	Readiness verification & group assignment
Page 2	Part 1: Warm-Up	City tourism headlines & Session 2 recall	Spoken definition of modal shift & externalities
Page 3	Part 2: Capacity Matrix	Venice, Amsterdam, Dubrovnik, Maya Bay data	Comparative evaluation of tourist pressure
Page 4	Part 3: Policy Pitch	Council pitch & commercial objection defense	Partner B active listening checklist & compromise
Page 5	Part 4: Grammar Clinic	Causatives of authority & contrast prepositions	Sentence transformation & TOEIC challenge check
Page 6	Part 5: DDRS Simulation	Isla Serena emergency water shortage summit	Signed 4-point Water Allocation Accord table
Page 7	Part 6: Wrap-Up	18-term glossary & Taboo fluency game	Personal learning log & pronunciation audit

Part 1: Tourism Policy News & Session 2 Vocabulary Review

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (City Headlines):** In pairs, discuss the two municipal headlines below. Ask your partner: *"Which measure addresses root causes rather than symptoms?"*
2. **Step 2 (Memory Recall):** Without consulting notes, interview your partner on 2 transport economics concepts from Session 2 (modal shift, externalities, decarbonization).
3. **Step 3 (Spot-Check):** Check definitions against the verification box below and record your self-assessment score.

📰 City Tourism Headlines in the International Press

Headline A: Venice Expands €5 Day-Tripper Access Ticket

Venice municipal council voted to double the pilot €5 entry fee to €10 on peak holiday weekends. City officials claim the levy deters short-stay crowds, but resident associations protest that it transforms their living city into a commercial theme park.

Speaking Prompt: Can an entry ticket genuinely manage city crowding?

Headline B: Amsterdam Freezes Central Hotel Construction

Amsterdam has banned all new hotel development and capped annual river cruise dockings. The city plans to relocate its sea cruise terminal outside the historic centre by 2035 to protect residential neighborhoods from street nuisance and overcrowding.

Speaking Prompt: Why are European capitals switching from promotion to containment?

🧠 Session 2 Vocabulary Retrieval Quick Check

Concept 01: Modal Shift — TRANSPORT MODE

Partner Question: What operational change does a modal shift represent?

Verification: A switch by passengers or freight from carbon-intensive modes (private cars, short-haul flights) to sustainable rail and transit.

Concept 02: Decarbonization — EMISSIONS CUT

Partner Question: How does decarbonization differ from carbon offsetting?

Verification: Eliminating greenhouse emissions directly at the source through fleet electrification and SAF, rather than paying for external offsets.

Concept 03: Externalities — SOCIAL COSTS

Partner Question: Why aren't externalities reflected in commercial travel prices?

Verification: Unintended side-effects (noise, nitrogen emissions, road wear) paid by society and taxpayers rather than private operators.

Concept 04: Lifecycle Assessment (LCA) — METHODOLOGY

Partner Question: What scope does a full lifecycle assessment cover?

Verification: Cradle-to-grave analysis evaluating environmental impacts from raw material extraction, through manufacturing and operation, to recycling.

✍️ Student Spoken Synthesis Notes

Record your partner's answer to: "Why is sustainable tourism governance crucial for local communities?"

Part 2: Destination Pressure & Carrying Capacity Matrix

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (Data Comparison):** Examine the 4 destination pressure profiles below. Calculate and compare the ratio of annual visitors to local permanent inhabitants.
2. **Step 2 (Comparative Analysis):** Use comparative structures (*far more intense, significantly higher ratio, whereas, while*) to explain social strains on housing, healthcare, and water.
3. **Step 3 (Policy Debate):** In pairs, decide which single municipal measure has generated the most durable community protection.

01. Venice, Italy — 49,000 residents

Annual Volume: 25+ Million Visitors (Ratio ~ 510:1)

Social Impacts: Severe residential depopulation (down from 175,000 in 1950), loss of neighborhood grocery stores replaced by souvenir stalls, extreme waterbus crowding.

Municipal Measures: Implemented €5 peak-day entrance fee for day-trippers; banned large cruise liners over 25,000 gross tonnes from the historic Giudecca Canal.

02. Dubrovnik, Croatia — 41,000 residents

Annual Volume: 1.5 Million Visitors (Walled city: <1,000 residents)

Social Impacts: "Game of Thrones" filming triggered massive crowd bottlenecks at the medieval Pile Gate; local services completely priced out by seasonal tourism rentals.

Municipal Measures: "Respect the City" programme: capped cruise ship arrivals to a maximum of 4,000 disembarking passengers simultaneously; installed AI crowd tracking cameras.

03. Amsterdam, Netherlands — 880,000 residents

Annual Volume: 20 Million Visitors

Social Impacts: Nuisance nightlife tourism in the central canal ring; proliferation of short-term holiday rentals drove rent prices up 65% in 8 years.

Municipal Measures: "Stay Away" demographic advertising campaigns; 30-night annual cap on short-term rentals; ban on new central souvenir shops and new hotel construction.

04. Maya Bay, Thailand — Protected National Park

Peak Influx: 5,000 Visitors / Day on a 250m Beach

Social Impacts: Boat propellers and toxic chemical sunscreens destroyed over 80% of native coral reefs; blacktip reef shark populations abandoned their natural nursery.

Municipal Measures: Complete 3.5-year closure for ecological regeneration; reopened with a strict 375-visitor hourly cap, mandatory boardwalks, and a boat ban inside the bay.

🗣️ Spoken Comparative Framework & Sentence Connectors

Expressing Contrast & Severity:

- *"While Amsterdam struggles with nightlife nuisance, Venice faces..."*
- *"Maya Bay's crisis is purely ecological, whereas Dubrovnik's is..."*
- *"The visitor-to-inhabitant ratio in Venice is dramatically higher than..."*

Evaluating Policy Effectiveness:

- *"An entry fee merely monetizes crowding rather than preventing it."*
- *"A complete seasonal closure proved far more effective because..."*
- *"Without hard legal caps on accommodation, day levies cannot..."*

✍️ Pair Discussion Deliverable: 45-Second Comparative Statement

Draft your comparative analysis evaluating the effectiveness of two municipal policies:

Part 3: Pitching New Tourism Policies to the Mayor

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (Policy Selection):** Select one municipal policy proposal from the grid below (Rental Quotas, Peak-Season Entry Levies, or Cruise Docking Bans).
2. **Step 2 (Role-Play Simulation):** Partner A acts as the Chief Sustainability Officer delivering a 2-minute pitch to City Council. Partner B acts as the Chamber of Commerce President voicing business objections.
3. **Step 3 (Peer Feedback):** Partner B completes the active listening evaluation checklist below. Together, negotiate an amended compromise policy.

POLICY OPTION A

Short-Term Rental Quota (Airbnb Cap)

Limit residential holiday rentals to a maximum of 30 nights per calendar year per primary residence. Require verified digital municipal licenses to protect housing affordability for nurses, students, and teachers.

Chamber of Commerce Objection: Infringes on private property ownership and deprives local property owners of supplemental income during inflation.

POLICY OPTION B

€10 Daily Peak-Season Entry Levy

Levy a €10 daily access charge on all non-resident day-trippers entering the historic perimeter during weekends and bank holidays, collected via regional train tickets and parking terminals.

Chamber of Commerce Objection: Retailers and restaurateurs fear day-trippers will divert their weekend spending to rival un-tolled neighboring regional towns.

POLICY OPTION C

Mega-Cruise Ship Port Moratorium

Prohibit passenger vessels exceeding 50,000 gross tonnes from berthing within 10 km of the historic harbour to eliminate heavy bunker fuel emissions and sudden 5,000-passenger crowd surges.

Chamber of Commerce Objection: Port authority and provisioning logistics operators lose millions in maritime docking tariffs and vessel refuelling contracts.

👥 Partner B: Active Listening & Peer Evaluation Checklist

Check criteria met during Partner A's 2-minute pitch

- ☐ **Clear Municipal Rationale:** Provided at least 2 concrete justifications (protecting housing, reducing street congestion, protecting heritage).
- ☐ **Precise Policy Lexis:** Accurately used at least 3 target terms (*carrying capacity, tourist levy, resident displacement, moratorium*).
- ☐ **Constructive Rebuttal:** Addressed business objections directly without dismissing commercial concerns or becoming aggressive.
- ☐ **Communicative Delivery:** Maintained audible volume, natural pacing, clear syllable stress, and engaging eye contact.

✍️ Final Policy Compromise Accord (Agreed between Sustainability Office & Chamber)

Summarize the amended terms that protect residents while preserving reasonable local commerce:

Part 4: Grammar Focus — Causatives of Authority & Contrast Connectors

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (Rule Review):** Study the 3 core grammar formulas below for expressing municipal rules and balancing competing viewpoints.
2. **Step 2 (Diagnostic Quiz):** Complete the 4 TOEIC-style test questions individually without consulting notes.
3. **Step 3 (Oral Transformation):** With your partner, create 2 original sentences applying *in spite of* and *make + bare infinitive* to your city policy pitch.

STRUCTURE 1

Causatives of Authority

```
Make + obj + bare V1
Require + obj + to–V1
Have + obj + done
```

Example: The city council *made tour companies limit* walking groups to 20 people.
Example: Officials *required hotels to install* low-flow water taps.

STRUCTURE 2

Contrast Prepositions

```
Despite + noun / gerund
In spite of + noun / gerund
❌ Never: *despite of
```

Example: *Despite higher tourist taxes*, hotel occupancy reached 94%.
Example: *In spite of banning* cruise ships, retail sales remained steady.

STRUCTURE 3

Concession Clauses

```
Clause 1, whereas + Clause 2
While + Clause 1, Clause 2
```

Example: Hoteliers celebrated peak summer revenue, *whereas local residents struggled* with nighttime noise.
Example: *While day-trippers spend little*, they consume public services.

📝 Interactive Grammar Challenge (TOEIC Parts 5 & 6 Traps)

1. _____ the daily visitor cap, historic canal bridges remained congested during the holiday.
(A) In spite of (B) Although (C) Because of (D) Whereas
✓ Key: (A) — Followed by noun phrase ("the daily visitor cap"). (B) requires subject + verb.

2. The municipal council _____ apartment owners register holiday rentals on an official database.
(A) made (B) required (C) let (D) had
✓ Key: (B) — Follows pattern "require + object + to-infinitive". "Make" takes bare infinitive.

3. Overnight guests support cultural museums, _____ day-trippers rarely purchase museum tickets.
(A) despite (B) in spite (C) whereas (D) because
✓ Key: (C) — "Whereas" links two complete contrasting clauses with balanced syntax.

4. Port authorities _____ cruise operators reschedule arrivals to avoid simultaneous docking surges.
(A) caused (B) forced to (C) made (D) allowed
✓ Key: (C) — "Made + operators + reschedule" uses causative of authority without "to".

✍️ Original Sentence Production (Write 2 Policy Sentences)

Sentence 1 (Use *in spite of + noun/gerund*):

Sentence 2 (Use *have/make someone do something*):

Part 5: DDRS Simulation — The Isla Serena Emergency Water Summit

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (Crisis Briefing):** Review the emergency dossier below. A 14-month drought has reduced island aquifers to an alarming 18% capacity while luxury resorts consume 800 L / guest / day.
2. **Step 2 (Role Allocation):** In teams of 4, assign roles (Mayor, Hotelier, Farmer, Environmental Regulator). Prepare your non-negotiable mandates.
3. **Step 3 (Emergency Summit):** Negotiate the Emergency Water Allocation Accord table below. Reach unanimous consensus across all 3 policy domains.

Emergency Crisis Dossier: Isla Serena Summer Drought

AQUIFER SHORTAGE: 18% CAPACITY

Situation: Isla Serena (Mediterranean island; permanent population: 24,000) experiences an August influx of 120,000 tourists. A 14-month drought has collapsed municipal reservoirs. Luxury coastal hotel resorts consume 800 liters of water per guest per day for private pools and tropical gardens, while local resident households face water cuts capped at 90 liters per person per day. Simultaneously, airport operators have proposed expanding the runway by 600 meters onto agricultural citrus groves to welcome wide-body long-haul jets.

Aquifer Level	Resort Consumption	Resident Quota	Runway Proposal
18% (Critical)	800 L / guest / day	90 L / resident / day	+600m on Farmland

Role A: The Town Mayor (Chair)
Must preserve municipal tax revenue and seasonal employment, but cannot allow residential taps to run dry. Needs a politically defensible compromise before August municipal elections.

Role B: The Hotel Association President
Represents 45 luxury hotels employing 1,500 local staff. Insists high-paying guests demand daily pools and lawns. Strongly supports runway expansion to attract direct premium flights.

Role C: The Organic Citrus Farmer
Produces olive oil and citrus. Demands agricultural water quotas to prevent tree death. Completely opposes runway expansion because it concretes fertile heritage agricultural land.

Role D: Environmental Protection Regulator
Warns that further aquifer pumping risks irreversible saltwater intrusion that will poison the island's groundwater for decades. Demands hard tourism caps and an immediate runway veto.

Emergency Water Allocation Accord (Binding Consensus Table)

Policy Domain	Initial Conflicting Position	Agreed Compromise Measure	Consensus
Hotel Pools & Landscaping	100% immediate shutdown demanded vs. unlimited luxury guest consumption.	Resorts convert pools to treated seawater; 40% mandatory reduction in irrigation.	AGREED
Household Water Quota	Rationing capped at 90 L/day vs. basic resident human rights standard.	Guaranteed baseline of 120 L/day; mobile desalination barge contracted.	AGREED
Airport Runway Expansion	Build +600m extension onto citrus groves vs. complete aviation ban.	Runway extension cancelled; airport capped at existing traffic with €15 eco-levy.	AGREED

Part 6: Vocabulary Wrap-Up, 18 Key Terms & Taboo Fluency Challenge

Student Instructions & Action Steps:

1. **Step 1 (Choral Audio Drill):** Review the 18 key overtourism terms below, checking syllable stress and operational definitions.
2. **Step 2 (45-Second Taboo Challenge):** Play the fast-paced speaking game in pairs. Describe your target term without uttering any of the 4 forbidden words!
3. **Step 3 (Session Learning Log):** Complete your personal reflection log and obtain your partner's signature.

📚 Master Glossary: 18 Key Overtourism Terms

Term & Pronunciation	Operational Definition	Term & Pronunciation	Operational Definition
Overtourism /ˌoʊ.və ˈtʊə.rɪ.zəm/	Excessive visitor volume causing social and ecological degradation.	**Visitor Dispersal** /dɪ ˈspɜː.səl/	Directing tourist crowds away from crowded centres to regional towns.
Carrying Capacity /kə ˈpæs.ə.ti/	Maximum visitors a site sustains without damaging local culture or nature.	**Honey-Pot Destination** / ˈhʌn.i pɒt/	Hyper-popular iconic site drawing disproportionate visitor densities.
De-Marketing /diː ˈmɑː.kɪ.tɪŋ/	Advertising strategies designed to discourage tourist arrivals.	**Infrastructure Strain** / ˈɪn.frəˌstrʌk.tʃər/	Overloading sewage, water, waste disposal, and transport capacity.
Tourist Levy /ˈtʊə.rɪst ˈlev.i/	Municipal tax charged per visitor night to fund public services.	**Surge Pricing** /sɜːdʒ ˈpraɪ.sɪŋ/	Dynamic pricing raising fees during peak hours to moderate flow.
Resident Backlash / ˈbæk.læʃ/	Local protests against housing displacement and noise nuisance.	**Seasonal Quota** /ˈsiː.zən.əl ˈkwoʊ.tə/	Enforceable legal limit on tourist entries during peak summer months.
Short-Term Rental /ˌʃɔːt tɜːm ˈren.təl/	Furnished residential flats leased to tourists rather than locals.	**Heritage Conservation** / ˈher.ɪ.tɪdʒ/	Preserving historical architecture, monuments, and indigenous ways of life.

🎮 45-Second Taboo Fluency Challenge Cards

TARGET CARD 01
Tourist Levy
Forbidden: Tax, Money, Pay, City

TARGET CARD 02
Carrying Capacity
Forbidden: Limit, Maximum, Crowd, Number

TARGET CARD 03
De-Marketing
Forbidden: Discourage, Advertising, Stop, Campaign

TARGET CARD 04
Resident Backlash
Forbidden: Anger, Protest, Local, People

TARGET CARD 05
Seasonal Quota
Forbidden: Summer, Limit, Number, Month

TARGET CARD 06
Honey-Pot Site
Forbidden: Popular, Famous, Landmark, Crowd

📝 Session 3 Personal Learning Log & Self-Assessment

1. Top 3 vocabulary items mastered today: _____

2. Pronunciation focus (syllable stress / vowel): _____

3. Grammar distinction to practice: _____

Student Signature: _____ **Peer Evaluator Signature:** _____ **Teacher Verification:** [ ] Pass